

Ash Cook [Hoyle]

Film curator

CONTACT

Phone: +1 610.333.2716

Email: ahoyale777@gmail.com

Address: 1658 Don Carlos Ave

Glendale, CA 91208

EDUCATION

Vassar College

Bachelor of the Arts

- Film & English double major
 - Jewish Studies minor
 - 3.7 GPA, summa cum laude
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sundance Institute | 2018–Present

Programmer

- Curatorial leader working at the top of the field in evaluating, assembling, and launching a world class program of 150 films from a pool of 17,000+
- Maintains and enriches critical artistic expertise and cultural competency across fiction, nonfiction, and genre work
- Cultivates and services industry relationships with artists, executives, arts organizations, and diplomatic bodies across the domestic US and around the globe
- Oversees engineering of festival slotting across 20+ screens, collaborating with venues and operations teams, negotiating with rights holders, and driving festival vision and budgetary modeling at a multi-million dollar scale
- Manages the planning and execution of annual awards presentations, industry activities, and offscreen programs
- Represents Sundance programming in the press, on juries, panels, and in forums around the world

Associate Features Programmer, Shorts Programmer

Assistant to the Director of Programming

Events Coordinator

Jewish Film Institute | 2023–Present

Festival Director, San Francisco Jewish Film Festival

- Oversees editorial vision and operational planning of the largest, longest running festival of its kind
- Engages with donors and funding bodies to advance the development goals of the organization
- Performs in speaking and press engagements for local and national audiences
- Moderates public Q&As with top tier filmmaking talent
- Composes curatorial notes and literary accompaniments to annual festival programs
- Utilizes field wide knowledge, scouting work, and networks to solicit and book globally recognized cinema works

FURTHER

Los Angeles Festival of Movies 2023–Present

Associate Director of Programming & Operations, Advisory Board Member

HEIGHTENED SCRUTINY Feature Film 2025

Distribution Consultant

OutFest Los Angeles 2021–2023

Senior Programmer

Damn These Heels Film Festival by Utah Film Center 2021

Director of Programming

Boise International Film Festival 2023–Present

Lead Programmer

A.C.

ADDITIONAL	Palm Springs International Shortfest Overlook Film Festival Sun Valley Film Festival NewFest New York Media Film Festival AFI Fest & AFI Doc Fest	Senior Programmer Programmer Associate Programmer Programming Committee Member Programmer Screener
PUBLISHED WORKS & AWARDS	Q Salt Lake Magazine SLUG Magazine Utah Stories The Mosaic Art & Literary Journal by University of California JAB Fiction & Poetry	Queer Art Mentorship Fellow 2026 Project Involve Fellow, Film Independent 2021 TrevorProject crisis counselor 2020 Best in Fest Sundance Volunteer Award 2018 Congressional Award Gold Medal Recipient 2014
LANGUAGES	Hebrew [proficient]	Spanish [proficient] ASL [beginner]
JURY POSITIONS	Who Let The Docs Out Chicago Palestine Film Festival SFFilm Short Film Competition Minikino International Jury Doc Edge Pitch Creative Capital Award JEONJU Cinema Project Overlook Film Festival SXSW Film & Television Festival Australian International Documentary Conference NewFest New York Sundance Institute Uprise Grant New Voices Filmmaker Grant by Netflix & NewFest Norwegian Short Film Festival Sundance Institute Ignite Fellowship Generation Equality Fear No Film Utah Arts Festival	Grant application reader 2026 Juror 2025 Juror 2024 Board Member 2024 Jury Member 2023 Reviewer 2024 Works in Progress Juror 2023 Shorts Juror 2023 Short Narrative Juror 2023 Guest Decision Maker 2023 US Narrative Feature Competition Juror 2022 Finalist Panelist 2022 Grant Evaluator 2022 Short Fiction Juror 2022 Reviewer 2021, 2026 Jury Member 2021 Jury Member 2020
SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS	Villanova University Film Department Yale University Film Department USC MA Program Palm Springs Shorfest Industry Forum Film Independent Youth Curator Program Vassar College Film Department Chapman University Film Department FestForums, Santa Barbara Jeonju International Film Festival, Korea AIDC REGIONality, New Zealand Minikino Film Market, Indonesia MoMA Teen Film Education Program Cine Circle Funding & Distribution Conference Transgender Film Center	Guest speaker 2026 Guest speaker 2026 Guest speaker 2025 "Future of Festivals" panelist 2025 Guest speaker 2025 Guest Lecturer 2021-Present Guest Lecturer 2023 "Contemplating the Future" panelist 2023 "Role of Film Festivals" panelist 2023 Industry roundtable speaker 2023 "Toast Your Short" panelist 2023 Guest speaker 2022-2024 Panelist 2024 Guest speaker 2024